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Virginia House of Delegates Floor Session, Joint Assembly, Saturday, January 17, 2026

Date	Saturday, January 17, 2026
Place	Virginia House of Delegates, House Chamber, State Capitol, Richmond
Length	0h 42m (video)

- Official floor video (House of Delegates archive, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0RDxiztNk6g
- LIS House minutes: https://lis.virginia.gov/session-details/20261/minutes-list/H

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Speech-to-text: whisper.cpp, model large-v3-turbo. Produced 2026-10-16. Each paragraph starts with its time [HH:MM:SS] in the meeting video.

[00:15:23] The House will come to order. Members, please take your seats. Sergeant-at-arms. The House is now in session. All persons not entitled to the privileges of the floor, please retire to the gallery.

[00:15:42] The members will rise and be led in prayer by Dr. Lucretia Mason Underdo, United Community Church, Portsmouth, and remain standing for the Pledge of Allegiance to the Flag of the United States of America, led by the Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring. Let us pray. Dear gracious and eternal God, we pause before the work of this day to acknowledge you as a source of all wisdom, all justice, and all truth.

[00:16:11] We thank you for the privilege of service and the responsibility that rests upon these delegates and upon the Speaker of the House. Grant them clarity of mind and humility of spirit as they deliberate and speak up for the needs, God, and concerns and interests of the people who elected them in position.

[00:16:34] Knowing this, God, we know that you will let their actions be guided not by self-interest but by the greater good of all in whom they serve. Give them the courage to do what is right, the patience to listen well, and the grace to work together even in moments of disagreement. We ask that this chamber be filled with respect, civility, and a shared commitment to justice. You brought them through last year and there's no doubt you'll bring them through this year. God, we also thank you for this moment in our Commonwealth's history and ask that you guide these delegates, senators, as they

[00:17:14] work in partnership with the governor, lead them with wisdom, humility, and courage. Bless this session, the work of their hands, and the people of this Commonwealth. We offer this prayer in faith and hope. Amen.

[00:17:31] Amen. Members will answer the roll call by indicating their presence on the electronic voting board.

[00:18:10] Clerk will close the roll. Mr. Speaker, a quorum is present. Pursuant to House Rule 3, I've examined and approved the journal of the House of Delegates for Friday, January 16, 2026. Motions of resolution under Rule 39 pursuant to the provisions of Rule 40 are now in order.

[00:18:29] Does the clerk have any announcements or communications? No, sir, not at this time. Are there further motions and resolutions under Rule 39? The time for the Joint Assembly has arrived. Sergeant at Orms. Mr. Speaker, the Senate of Virginia.

[00:18:46] The members of the House will rise and receive the Senate of Virginia.

[00:19:22] Joint Assembly will come to order.

[00:19:45] The clerk of the Senate will call the roll of the Senate. Senators Aird, Senator Bagby, Senator Boydcoe, Senator Carol Foy, Senator Cyphers, Senator Craig, Senator Deeds, Senator Deesteph, Senator Diggs, Senator Durant, Senator Eben, Senator

[00:20:16] Vola, Senator French, Senator Hackworth, Senator Hashmi, Senator Head, Senator Jordan, Senator Locke, Senator Lucas, Senator Marsden, Senator McDougal, Senator McPike, Senator Mulcahy, Senator Obenshain, Senator Peake, Senator Bukorski, Senator Perry, Senator Pillian,

[00:20:50] Senator Reeves, Senator Rome, Senator Rouse, Senator Salim, Senator Sandy Vison, Senator Stanley, Senator Stanley, Senator Stewart, Senator Sturdivant, Senator Suterland, Senator Servell, Senator Van Valkenburg, Senator Williams. You have a quorum, Mr. President.

[00:21:25] The members of the House will indicate their presence on the Electronic Voting Board.

[00:21:41] Clerk will close the row. Mr. President, a quorum is present. The Joint Assembly is duly organized and ready to proceed. I excuse those inaugural committee members participating in the 2026 inauguration motorcade so they're coming just for yeah if you just yeah exactly just stay

[00:22:09] there and yeah they're just the two motorcades so vivian and um them are gone

[00:22:26] the joint assembly will be at ease the joint assembly will be at ease ideally but they're

[00:25:31] not playing ideal yes sir joint assembly will come to order sergeant at arms mr president the mayor of the city of richmond the honorable dr danny avula mr president the honorable mark r

[00:25:59] Warner, Senior United States Senator from Virginia. Mr. President, the Honorable Timothy M. Cain, Junior United States Senator from Virginia. Mr. President, the Honorable Rob Whitman,

[00:26:30] Representative from Virginia's 1st Congressional District. Mr. President, the Honorable Jen Kiggins, Representative from Virginia's 2nd Congressional District. Mr. President, the Honorable Robert C. Scott, Representative from Virginia's 3rd Congressional District.

[00:26:59] Mr. President, the Honorable Jennifer L. McClellan, representative from Virginia's 4th Congressional District. Mr. President, the Honorable John J. McGuire III, representative from Virginia's

5th Congressional District.

[00:27:29] Mr. President, the Honorable Eugene Vindman, representative from Virginia's 7th Congressional District. Mr. President, the Honorable Donald S. Baer Jr., representative from Virginia's 8th Congressional District.

[00:27:53] Mr. President, the Honorable H. Morgan Griffith, representative from Virginia's 9th Congressional District. Mr. President, the Honorable Suhesk Subramaniam, representative from Virginia's 10th Congressional District.

[00:28:19] Morgan Griffith, representative from Virginia's... Mr. President, the Honorable James Walkinshaw, representative from Virginia's 11th Congressional District. Mr. President, the Honorable Adam Schiff, United States Senator from California.

[00:28:43] Mr. President, the Honorable Alyssa Slotkin, United States Senator from Michigan. Mr. President, the Honorable Jim Himes.

[00:29:02] No. Pete Aguilar, Representative from California's 33rd Congressional District. Mr. President, the Honorable Jim Himes, Representative from Connecticut's 4th Congressional District.

[00:29:25] Mr. President, the Honorable Cherise Davids, Representative from Kansas' 3rd Congressional District. Mr. President, the Honorable Jamie Raskin.

[00:29:53] Mr. President, the Honorable Hakeem Jeffries, representative from New York's 8th Congressional District. Mr. President, the Honorable Christina Houlihan,

[00:30:33] representative from Pennsylvania's 6th Congressional District. Mr. President, the Honorable Lizzie Fletcher, representative from Texas' 7th Congressional District.

[00:31:02] Mr. President, the Governor of Maryland, The Honorable Wes Moore.

[00:31:22] Mr. President, the Lieutenant Governor of Maryland, the Honorable Aruna Miller.

[00:31:42] Mr. President, the Attorney General of Illinois, the Honorable Kwame Raul. He's not here. Mr. President, members of Governor Youngkin's cabinet.

[00:32:01] - Okay, keep it moving. - Mr. President, the Chief Justice and Justices of the Supreme Court of Virginia.

[00:32:26] Mr. President, the Chairman and Commissioners of the State Corporation Commission.

[00:32:43] Mr. President, former Governor of Virginia, the Honorable L. Douglas Wilder.

[00:33:14] Mr. President, former Governor and U.S. Senator from Virginia, the Honorable George F. Allen.

[00:33:32] Mr. President, former Governor of Virginia, the Honorable James S. Gilmore III.

[00:33:47] Mr. President, former Governor of Virginia, the Honorable Robert F. McDonald.

[00:34:04] Mr. President, former Governor of Virginia, the Honorable Terrence R. McAuliffe.

[00:34:20] Mr. President, former Governor of Virginia, the Honorable Ralph S. Northam. Mr. President, former Speaker of the Virginia House of Delegates, the Honorable C. Todd Gilbert.

[00:34:58] Mr. President, former Speaker of the Virginia House of Delegates, the Honorable Eileen Filler Corn. Mr. President, former Speaker of the Virginia House of Delegates, the Honorable M. Kirkland Cox.

[00:35:30] Mr. President, Chief of the Chiro Oanhaka Nottoway Indian Tribe, Walt Redhawk Brown.

[00:35:53] Mr. President, the Chief of the Chickahominy Indian Tribe, Stephen R. Adkins. Mr. President, Representative of the Chickahominy Tribe of Eastern Division, Tim Emery.

[00:36:19] Mr. President, the Chief of the Mattapunai Indian Tribe, Mark T. Falling Star Custolo. Mr. President, the Chief of the Upper Mattapanai Indian Tribe, W. Frank Adams.

[00:36:49] Mr. President, the Chief of the Monacan Indian Nation, Diane Shields.

[00:37:04] Mr. President, the Chief of the Nanseman Indian Nation, Keith Anderson. Mr. President, the Chief of the Nottoway Indian Tribe of Virginia, Lynette Alston.

[00:37:29] Mr. President, the Chief of the Pamunkey Indian Tribe of Virginia, Kevin Brown. Mr. President, the Chief of the Potomac Indians of Virginia, Charles Bullock.

[00:37:59] Members and guests may be seated. Delegate, the delegate from Chesapeake, Delegate Hayes.

[00:38:25] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for the purpose of an introduction. Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, we were prayed for over this session this morning by Elder Lucretia Mason Underdue. She is of the United Community Church in Portsmouth.

[00:38:43] She's a native of Dendron, Virginia, whose life and work reflect a deep commitment to her faiths and the community. She has spent her career caring for others as a school counselor in Portsmouth Public Schools and as a qualified mental health counselor in the Commonwealth, supporting individuals and families with compassionate care.

[00:39:06] Please join me as we extend to her a warm house welcome.

[00:39:20] Welcome, Dr. Underdoin. Thank you for being here today. I would ask—the Joint Assembly will come to order, especially you rabble-rousers in the back.

[00:39:42] I would ask the members of the inaugural committee to depart the chamber and proceed directly to the old house chamber to assemble for introduction on the portico. As your teacher would say, quietly.

[00:40:41] Finally, I would ask the remaining members of the Joint Assembly and staff to join me and depart the chamber and proceed directly to your designated seat on the portico. The Joint Assembly shall reconvene on the portico for the inauguration ceremony.

